

ideas and boil them down to their simplest forms. His talk was based on the important lessons he had uncovered in his interviews with the world's top traders. Three key insights resonated with me, and changed my previous conceptions about trading.

1. *Trading is not reserved for the world's most elite.* The traders he interviewed came from various backgrounds. There was no correlation between trading success and school or prior occupation. The commonality of the traders was traced to hard work and determination, and their desire to unlock the puzzle of the market. They all shared an aspiration to avoid the psychological impediments that prevented most people from winning in the markets.

2. *Trading is not just a science, but also an art.* Even those traders who use a purely systematic approach to tackling the markets are still engaged in creative thinking. None of the traders he discussed stepped into an already working formula; nobody was handed a blueprint. Their success was built on the backbone of their ability to discover what others overlooked.

3. *There is no single right way to make money.* Those who succeed do so because they find what works for them. Trying to replicate someone else's method almost always results in failure. All successful traders have their own methodology, an approach that makes sense to them and that they are comfortable with.

The talk concluded with a question-and-answer session. To my surprise, the industry professionals had some questions very similar to my own. I realized then that there was not as much that divided us as I had originally assumed. We all wanted to know and understand more, including my own father, as this desire was what had set him out on his quest to interview these Market Wizards many years earlier.

I have had the honor of getting to work with my dad on this book, which is not meant to imply that I have done much at all. I have simply had the privilege of sharing my impressions and suggestions after reading each chapter as he completed them. The amount of work that my father puts into these books is just incredible. I was amazed at the time it takes to go through the many hours of tapes to formulate a chapter. People often tell my dad he is a great interviewer, to which he frequently replies, "I am a